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Travel Radio Australia, we are in Cannes in France at this IGTG fabulous golf event for the IG travel market and I have here a lovely lady from Australia, Tracey Lowry from Travel Managers in Anglesey in Victoria and you're a long way from home Trace. Yes I am Jeff but very excited to be here. Tell us a bit about your company Travel Managers Anglesey, what's it all about? So I look after people's travel arrangements, we do groups, golf tours all around the world and I also look after leisure travel as well so for my clients that like to travel and cruise and yeah just pretty much look after all their arrangements and help them with all their bookings.

It's a big world out there and tell us about some of the regions that you specialise in and the cruises you specialise in. Yeah so primarily my market is Europe, Australians love to go to Europe so and Canada or Alaska. The cruising is very popular on the Danube so river cruising is very very popular and also Alaskan cruising so along the coast.

Well I live in Amsterdam for six months of the year and there's so many thousands and thousands of Australians coming through Amsterdam to jump on those beautiful Rhine river cruises. Do you handle some of those as well? Yes I do yes so and I use all the cruise lines APT, Scenic, Armour Waterways, Viking yeah all of those cruise companies and it's very popular. These are those beautiful flat boats aren't they and they're big ships really but they're they're flat so you're not on the big waves you just have a beautiful beautiful cruise down the Rhine.

Tell us a bit about the schedule that they go on. It's obviously down the Danube and the beauty of river cruising is that you only unpack once the ship moves at night it's lovely and smooth and each day you wake up in a beautiful little village and you're docked right there so you can just walk step off the boat and you're inside in the beautiful villages and you can go and explore by foot or the cruise companies do also offer day excursions and things like that so it's a great way to travel yeah. And what about some of your other packages apart from the cruises tell us a bit about those.

We do the Rocky Mountaineer in Canada, Alaskan Cruising as I mentioned they usually go hand in hand we have some great Camino packages for people who like to hike the Camino packages that we've put together over the years. What are your impressions we're sitting here at Cannes on the French Riviera on the Côte d'Azur what are your impressions of this area? It's very beautiful I would have loved more time to explore here I have been here a couple of times it's never enough you always want to come back it's so beautiful around this region it's just amazing. And tell us a bit about your background how did you get into travel in the first place? So I've been in travel for 35 years pretty much loved to travel and ended up yeah making a career out of it went to travel college and got my certificate and away I went pretty much and all of it is learning in the office hands-on and traveling yourself the knowledge and experience you get from traveling yourself is very vital in this role in this job.

Some of your favorite destinations in Europe? I do love Sicily I love gorgeous little place called San Vito in Sicily it's a little gem there and near Trapani which is absolutely beautiful I love Portugal. Porto is beautiful isn't it Porto if you get a chance to see Porto it's just fantastic. Yeah beautiful city beautiful everyone I send there just loves it so it's very universal.

And describe Porto for us how would you describe it? It's very traditional it's hilly so you've got to remember that it's really got a great vibe about it it's safe to get around and with the new river cruising there as well it's becoming more and more popular. Now we must say this because there's a new initiative by the European Union when people are coming from outside like Australia they have the fingerprint and facial recognition process tell us a bit about that. That is something that has recently been introduced and it's actually also going to be hand-in-hand with a new visa system a visa system for Australian travelers we believe that's going to come in early next year so if this is just pretty much phase one of that process so it's it's super easy it's facial recognition fingerprint you hold your four fingers down on the screen and it's it's super easy.

They've already got all your details on your passport anyway and and this is this initiative is to stop people overstaying because the way it works is you're allowed 90 days in 180 day period which is plenty of time to see Europe you've got whole three months to see Europe. Correct exactly they really do not like you to overstay that so they really want to crack down on it and as you said three months is plenty of time to to see everything so yeah. I've had this program in the United States for the last 30 years if you've ever been to America you would have gone through the same system and it is very easy and like I that is on the system for three years so if you don't travel it drops off the system but you once you've done it once that's it you don't have to worry.

Yeah that's it it's not as daunting as it sounds it's actually very easy yeah. Now I'm chatting with Tracy Lowry from Travel Managers Anglesea in Victoria all the way here into Europe at Cannes and the French Riviera and Tracy how can people find out more about Travel Managers Anglesea online? Go to my website www.travelmanagers.com.au slash Tracy Lowry. And thank you so much for being here with us in Cannes all you lovely people out there in Victoria and across Australia if you'd like Tracy to organise your whole European trip she's she's there at your disposal.

Wonderful thank you Geoff.